

MOTIVATION

According to Morgan & King

A Comprehensive Study of Human Motivation

Morgan & King · Principles of Psychology · 1975

✓ **Concept of
Motivation**

✓ **Instincts & Drives**

✓ **Types of Motivation**

✓ **Theories of
Motivation**

1. Concept of Motivation

Motivation refers to the internal state or condition that energizes, directs, and maintains behavior toward a goal. It explains why an individual behaves in a particular way, initiates actions, and persists despite obstacles.

"Motivation refers to states within the organism that activate behavior and direct it toward goals."

— Morgan and King (1975)

Characteristics of Motivation

- It activates behavior.
- It directs behavior toward a goal.
- It sustains behavior until the goal is achieved.
- It can arise from physiological or psychological needs.
- Motivation varies in intensity among individuals.

Components of Motivation

Component	Definition	Example
Need	A state of deprivation or deficiency. Creates tension within the individual.	Lack of food produces hunger.
Drive	An aroused state resulting from a need. Pushes an organism to act.	Hunger motivates searching for food.
Incentive	External object or event that attracts or repels behavior.	Delicious food, money, praise.
Goal	The desired outcome that satisfies the need and reduces tension.	—

2. Sources of Motivation

Morgan and King emphasized that motivation arises from instincts, drives, and incentives.

A. Instincts

Instincts are innate, biologically inherited patterns of behavior that occur without prior learning.

Characteristics • Inborn
and universal.

- Species-specific.
- Triggered by particular stimuli.
- Adaptive for survival.

Instinct Theory

Early psychologists believed that most human behavior was guided by instincts.

William James	William McDougall
Suggested humans possess numerous instincts such as: Fear, Love, Curiosity, Sociability, Anger	Proposed several instincts, including: Escape, Combat, Curiosity, Repulsion, Acquisition, Parental instinct

Criticism of Instinct Theory

- Too many instincts were proposed.
- Difficult to verify scientifically.
- Human behavior is strongly influenced by learning and culture.
- Does not explain individual differences.

B. Drives

A drive is an internal state of tension that motivates behavior aimed at reducing that tension.

Drive Characteristics

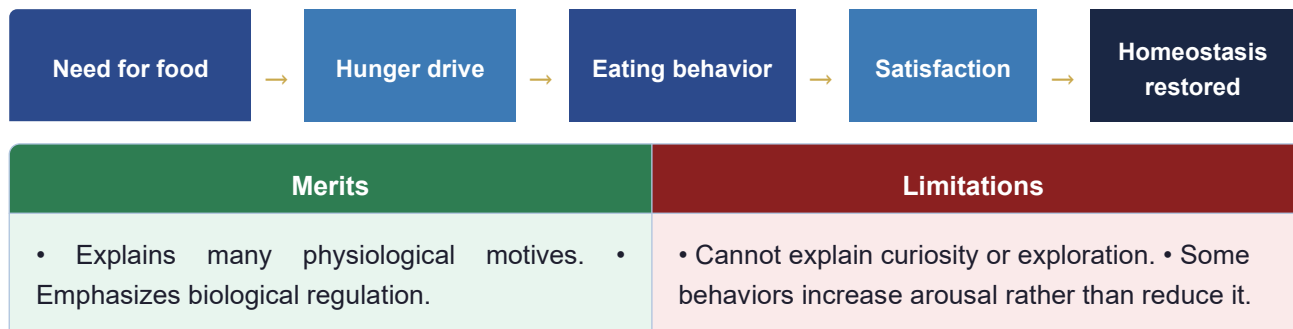
- Produced by physiological needs.
- Energizes behavior.
- Persists until the need is satisfied.

Examples: Hunger, Thirst, Need for sleep, Sex drive

Drive Reduction Theory — Developed by Clark Hull

Main Assumptions

- Biological needs create deprivation.
- Deprivation leads to drives.
- Drives motivate behavior.
- Behavior reduces the drive.
- Reduction restores homeostasis.



3. Types of Motivation

Type	Description	Characteristics	Examples
Biological (Physiological)	Arises from bodily needs essential for survival.	Innate; Necessary for survival; Regulated by homeostasis.	Hunger, Thirst, Sleep, Sex, Pain avoidance
Social	Learned motives that develop through interaction with society.	Acquired through experience; Culture-dependent.	Achievement, Affiliation, Power, Status, Recognition
Intrinsic	Behavior performed because it is personally rewarding.	Interest-based; Self-satisfying; Long-lasting.	Reading for enjoyment; Learning psychology due to curiosity.
Extrinsic	Behavior influenced by external rewards or punishments.	Externally driven; May reduce intrinsic interest.	Studying for grades; Working for salary; Exercising for praise.

Major Social Motives

Need for Achievement (nAch)	Desire to excel and attain standards of excellence.
Need for Affiliation	Need to establish and maintain interpersonal relationships.
Need for Power	Desire to influence or control others.

4. Theories of Motivation

1

Instinct Theory

Proponents: William James and McDougall

Behavior is governed by innate instincts.

Strengths

- Explains species-specific behavior.
- Highlights biological influences.

Weaknesses

- Ignores learning and environment.
- Difficult to test scientifically.

2

Drive Reduction Theory

Proponent: Clark Hull

Behavior occurs to reduce internal tension and maintain homeostasis.

Formula:



3

Arousal Theory

Suggests that individuals seek an optimal level of arousal. People are motivated to maintain a balance between boredom and overstimulation. Examples: Adventure sports, Solving puzzles, Watching exciting movies.

Yerkes–Dodson Principle: Performance is best at moderate levels of arousal.

Arousal Level	Performance
Too little arousal	Poor performance
Moderate arousal	Best performance
Excessive arousal	Performance declines

4

Incentive Theory

Behavior is influenced by external rewards and incentives.

Examples: Bonus payments, Trophies, Praise, Scholarships.

5

Humanistic Theory (Maslow)

Developed by Abraham Maslow

Motivation is driven by the desire for personal growth and self-fulfillment.

Hierarchy of Needs

5	Self-Actualization	Achieving one's fullest potential
4	Esteem Needs	Status, recognition, self-respect
3	Love & Belongingness	Affection, relationships, belonging
2	Safety Needs	Security, stability, freedom from fear
1	Physiological Needs	Food, water, sleep, shelter

Self-Actualization: Achieving one's fullest potential and becoming what one is capable of being.

Strengths

- Addresses the full range of human needs.
- Emphasizes personal growth.

Weaknesses

- Difficult to measure scientifically.
- Needs may not always follow a strict hierarchy.

Summary

Morgan and King view motivation as a process that energizes, directs, and sustains behavior toward goals. Motivation originates from instincts, drives, incentives, and psychological needs, and is explained through theories such as Instinct Theory, Drive Reduction Theory, Arousal Theory, Incentive Theory, and Maslow's Humanistic Theory. These theories together provide a comprehensive understanding of why humans initiate, maintain, and regulate their behavior.